SOP-CUSTOMER COMPLAINT HANDLING

[CONFIDENTIAL]

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CHANGE HISTORY

This section describes the details of changes that have resulted in the current document.

SL. No.	Document Version No.	Change Description	Reason For change	Prepared By & Date	Reviewed By & Date	Approved By & Date
01	Issue B V 0.1	Implementation of the Integrated Management System	ISO 9001:2015 & ISO 80079-34 Ed.2 requirement are incorporated	Vinothkumar. P.S 10-Dec-2025	Santosh V 12-Dec-2025	
02	V 1.0					Sanmangala M S 12-Dec-2025

1 Purpose

To define a standard procedure to receive a customer complaint and the method followed to resolve the complaint by analyzing and taking the suitable corrective and preventive action.

2 Scope

This procedure applies to all customer complaints related to product, service, safety, delivery, documentation, or compliance for all products, including Ex (explosion-protected) equipment.

3 Abbreviations

1. NC: Non-Conformance
2. NCR: Non-Conformance Report
3. Ex – Explosive
4. CAPA – Corrective Action & Preventive Action
5. KPI – Key Point Indicator
6. RCCA – Root Cause & Corrective Action
7. RCA – Root Cause Analysis
8. EPL – Equipment Protection Level

4 Terms and Definitions

Complaint: Any expression of dissatisfaction received from a customer regarding the organization's products or services.

NC (Nonconformity): Deviation from a requirement.

Significant Complaint (Ex Equipment): Any complaint affecting compliance with explosion-protection design, marking, safety, or certification.

5 Responsibilities

Project Manager / Business Head: Receives and logs complaints.

Quality Assurance Manager: Ensures evaluation, investigation, risk assessment, and closure.

Production & Quality: Supports technical analysis and root cause identification.

Production / Concerned Process Owner: Implements containment and corrective actions.

Ex-Representative: Reviews of complaints affecting explosion-protection conformity.

6 RACI

Process	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed
Customer Complaint	Project Manager / Business Head	Quality Assurance Manager	PM/BU Head/Delivery Head/Head Quality/Sales Head	Customer / Top Management/Sales Head

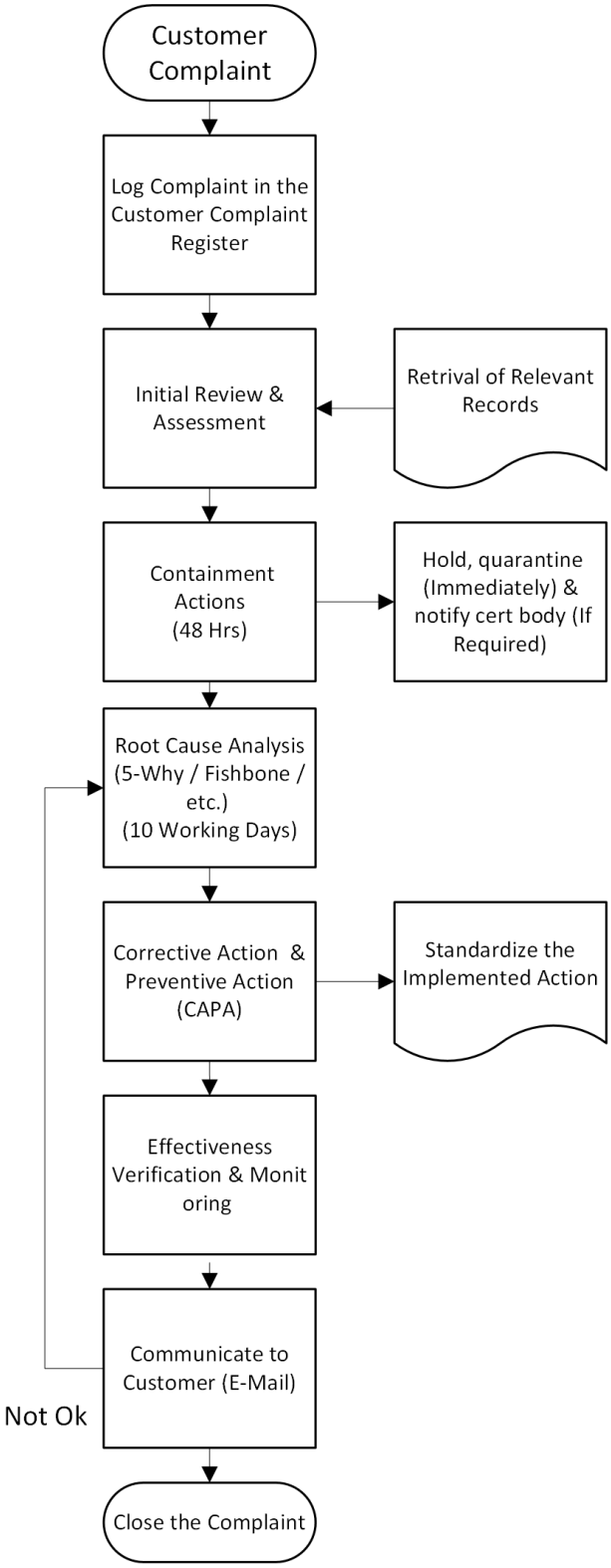
7 SIPOC

Customer Escalation

Supplier	Input	Process and Control		Output	Customer
		Process	Control		
Customer	E-mail / NCR raised by customer	Customer Complaint Handling	Root cause analysis, and the implementation of the CAPA and effectiveness monitoring	NCR Report, with relevant supporting documents,	Implemented CAPA Report / Customer requested templated

8 Overall Process Flow Chart

a. Customer Complaint Handling



9 Process Description

5.1 Complaint Receipt & Logging

a. Complaints may be received via email, phone, service reports, or online forms.
b. Nonconformance report is updated with following details,
   - Date received
   - Customer name, contact
   - Product details, serial/batch number
   - Description of issue
   - Safety implications
   - Photos, documents (if provided)
c. Complaint is assigned a unique ID and logged in the Non-Conformance Register.

5.2 Containment Action

a. Complaint is to be acknowledged to the customer within 48 hours.
b. Expected investigation timeline and any request any missing information is to be communicated.

5.3 Initial Review & Assessment

Quality Manager / Ex-Representative performs a preliminary evaluation to determine:

a. Whether the complaint relates to product nonconformity.
b. If the issue impacts **Ex compliance** (marking, documentation, EPL/Category requirements, temperatures, safety functions).
c. Severity, frequency, and potential risks to safety or regulatory compliance.
d. Need for **immediate containment** (e.g., product hold, recall, notification to certification body—per ISO 80079-34).

5.4 Containment Actions

If necessary, initiate immediate actions to prevent further use or shipment of potentially affected products:

a. Segregate or quarantine stock.
b. Suspend related production processes.
c. Notify suppliers and service provider.
d. For Ex equipment, evaluate whether certification authorities must be informed (per certification scheme).

Record containment actions taken.

5.5 Root Cause Analysis

a. Quality and production will conduct the investigation and if required support from engineering (customer) with sought.
b. Evidence required to be collected as required: returned product inspection, test reports, supplier data, traceability review (ISO 80079-34 requirement).
c. Root cause analysis shall be conducted using any methods like 5-Why, Fishbone, Fault Tree, etc.
d. Determine:
   - Root cause(s)
   - Systemic issues
   - Whether the complaint confirms a customer-identified product failure
e. The findings are documented.

5.6 Corrective Actions

If a nonconformity is confirmed, Corrective Action is to be initiated, with following details.

a. Corrective actions addressing root cause and recurrence prevention.
b. Responsibilities and deadlines.
c. Actions do not negatively affect certified Ex design or marking.
d. Effectiveness after implementation.
e. If changes affect Ex certification, the change control and notification process shall be triggered as required.

5.7 Communication with Customer

Project Manager, Quality Assurance Manager or Ex representative provides:

a. Investigation results
b. Root cause summary (without proprietary details)
c. Corrective/containment actions taken
d. Recommendations or replacement/repair arrangements
e. Safety-related instructions if applicable

All communications are recorded.

5.8 Record Control

The following are the controlled records:

a. Non-conformance Register
b. Investigation documents
c. Non-conformance reports
d. Customer communication

e. Traceability records (for Ex equipment)

Retention period of minimum 10 years record shall be maintained,

5.9 Data Analysis & Management Review

Quality Manager / Ex-representative performs periodic analysis of complaints to identify recurring issues, trends, and possible systemic failures.
Results are reported in Management Review, including:

a. Complaint statistics
b. Severity and safety impact
c. Effectiveness of corrective actions
d. Required improvements to the QMS or processes

10 Information Security requirements

a. Information Security incidents and complaints are logged and closed appropriately
b. Confidentiality of information and project details is maintained by the team
c. Archiving and back up of data as per contractual obligations

11 Metrics

a. Total complaint received vs complaints closed
b. Ex-related complaint occurrences
c. Response time with containment
d. CAPA submission time

12 References

a. ISO 9001 Clauses 4.2, 8.2, 8.5, 9.1
b. ISO 80079-34:2018 Clauses 4.2, 8.2, 8.5, 9.1
c. ISO 27001 Clauses 4.2, 8.1, Controls A.16
d. ISMS Control Policies

13 Annexures

a. NIL

14 Forms

a. Customer Feedback Form UT/PS/CFP/TMP/01
b. Non-Conformance Register UT/MFG/CAPA/TMP/20
c. Non-Conformance Report UT/MFG/CAPA/TMP/24